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28 March 1974
SUPERSEDING
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30 October 1972

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TOWEL PACK, SURGICAL

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a sterile, disposable towel pack used for major and minor surgery.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification, to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.

Military

MIL-S-36586	Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.
MIL-F-36901	Fabric, Nonwoven, Disposable, Components for Packs.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

FSC 6530

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2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION PUBLICATION:

Pharmacopeia of the United States.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pa.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Nonwoven fabric, dimensions, quantity and assembly of component. Components in the immediate package shall be functionally folded and sequence packed for use. Components shall conform to the requirements specified in table I.

TABLE I

Type Nonwoven Fabric - MIL-F-36901	Component	No. Required	Minimum Dimensions (inches) Before Sterilization
I-IA-IB-IC	Outerwrap	1	Sufficient size to permit optimum aspetic technique.
V-A	Towels	4	width-19 area-494 square

Tolerance: The dimensions shall not vary more than 10% after sterilization.

3.2 Sterility. The towel pack in its immediate container shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.3.

3.2.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item Identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.

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k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Suppore Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.2.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.3 Folding. All components including the outerwrap shall be folded for optimum aseptic techniques.

3.4 Instructions. All components shall be identified, except the outerwrap which may be left unidentified, at the manufacturer's option. Opening and unfolding methods related to the components functional use shall be designated, except the utility drapes, drape sheets, outerwrap and towels which may be undesignated at the manufacturer's option.

3.5 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The towel packs shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made avialable for review to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the components listed in 3.1, may be furnished in lieu of acutal performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the component or material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements. Where certificates of quality are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Visual examination. Sampling for visual examination shall be performed with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Components. Sampling for examination shall be performed on component lots (see Table II).

Table II

	Inspection level	AQL (defects per hundred)
Major Defects	S-3	2.5
Minor Defects	S-3	4.0

4.2.2 End item. Sampling for end item examination shall be in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.3 Classification of defects. The components and end item shall be visually examined for the defects listed.

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Table III. Classification of defects*

Components	
MAJOR	
101	Component not functionally folded.
102	Printed component identification and unfolding designations omitted, incorrect or illegible or not on proper components (when applicable).
103	Printed component identification and unfolding designations not free of bleeding into material (when applicable).
104	Components not free of holes and tears.
105	Components not clean, not free from loose or harmful foreign matter.
106	Glued seam open or not properly secured.
MINOR	
102	Component not specified length and width.
	END ITEM
MAJOR	
101	Any component missing.
102	Paper Bag not properly sealed.
103	Paper Bag not properly marked.
104	Plastic Bag damaged.
105	Plastic Bag not properly marked.

*Defects shall not be limited to those listed above.

4.2.4 Compliance with the 10 percent variation in dimensions of components shall be determined by recording the dimension of a test pack prior to sterilizing and checking the dimensions of that pack after sterilization. If the dimensions after sterilization are within 10 percent of dimensions prior to sterilization, this shall constitute compliance with the 10 percent allowed variation. If a failure is noted, the lot shall be sampled utilizing inspection Level S-3 and AQL of 2.5.

4.3 Sterility test. The towel pack shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for purified cotton, gauze, surgical dressings and related material using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.3.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units.

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4.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.3.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.3 Sterility test and 4.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.3.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.3.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.3.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the U.S.P.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package, containing 24 towels packs, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

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5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Individual package. Four towels enclosed in a non-woven white outerwrap as specified in 3.1 shall be inserted into a heat sealed, sterilizable, tamperproof, white 40 lb (24 x 36 - 500) kraft barrier paper bag. The bag shall be provided with a tear string or tear tape to facilitate opening. The bag shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened. In addition, six individual packages shall be further inserted into a clear polyethylene bag having a minimum thickness of 0.003 inches. Closure of the polyethylene bag shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents under normal handling.

5.1.2.2 Unit package. Each unit (4 polyethylene bags containing 6 packs each) shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant, V3c. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix and waterproofing shall conform to 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

5.1.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Levels A and C. Units packed as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.1.3 shall require no further packing.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package.

5.3.1.1 Paper bag. In addition to any commercial markings, each paper bag shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. In addition, marking shall include the name of the contractor and the legend: "STERILE" and "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED." or similar statement.

5.3.1.2 Plastic bag. Each polyethylene bag shall be marked with the legend: "CAUTION: PLASTIC BAG SHOULD BE REMOVED PRIOR TO USE IN HAZARDOUS ATMOSPHERE." As an alternate, the caution legend may be shown on the strip of tape used to close the polyethylene bag or the tape may be placed over the top of the bag.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with the requirements for the exterior container as specified in MIL-STD-129. In addition, the sterility lot (control) number and the method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, C-Cold, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and the date of packaging. Example: "A/5/71-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procuring documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 The towel pack covered by this specification, is listed in the Federal Supply Catalog under the following stock number:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6530-00-110-1854	TOWEL PACK, SURGICAL, 24s

6.3 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, or sizes, of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet military requirements.

6.4 Intended use. The surgical pack covered by this specification is for use in major and minor surgery.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project Number: 6530-1298

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-T-36916A

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS	CONTRACT NUMBER
	MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A ☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

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